INCH-POUND

A-A-20158B
July 22, 1993
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20158A
June 29, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SALMON, CANNED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification PP-S-31F and Product Purchase Description PPD-05-S-003E.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers canned salmon, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The canned salmon shall conform to one or more of the following species, styles, and salt/sodium levels as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. Canned salmon shall meet the requirements of 21 CFR Part 161.170.

Species.

Oncorhynchus tshawytscha	- Chinook, king, spring
Oncorhynchus nerka	- Blueback, red, sockeye
Oncorhynchus kisutch	- Coho, cohoe, medium red, silver
Oncorhynchus gorbuscha	- Pink
Oncorhynchus keta	- Chum, keta

Styles.

Style I - Regular - skin and bones included
Style II - Special - skinless and backbone removed

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Technical Services Unit, Inspection Services Division, National Marine Fisheries Service, U.S. Department of Commerce, One Blackburn Drive, Gloucester, MA 01930.

FSC 8905/8940

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Salt/Sodium levels.

Level a - Regular (no more than 1.5 percent salt)
Level b - No salt added (no sodium chloride added during processing)
Level c - Very low sodium (35 milligrams or less sodium per serving)
Level d - Low sodium (140 milligrams or less sodium per serving)

Processing.

Only current season, fresh or RSW (Refrigerated Sea Water) unintentionally partially frozen, salmon shall be used for the product. The product shall be derived from raw material having characteristics that are indicative of good quality salmon, including, but not limited to, firmness of flesh, color typical of the species, and no off-odor of the gills and gut cavity. The washed salmon shall be free of objectionable material, including but not limited to, heads, viscera, and fins.

Watermarked salmon shall not be used.

Hatchery brood carcasses shall not be used.

The salmon and oil shall conform to the following product characteristics:

TABLE I. Product characteristics

Species	Color of oil	Color of flesh	Texture of fish
Chinook, king, spring	Light red through orange to almost white	Red to orange red to light pink	Moderately firm to soft
Blueback, red, sockeye	Deep red to deep orange	Dark red to orange red	Very firm to soft
Coho, cohoe, medium red, silver	Light red to yellowish pink	Red to orange red to light pink	Moderately firm to soft
Pink	Pink to light yellow	Pink to buff	Moderately firm to soft (but not mushy)
Chum, keta	Light pink with orange shade to yellow	Light pink to grayish white	Moderately firm to firm

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Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC.

Test	Chapter and Section		Paragraph Number
Salt (Sodium Chloride)	Chapter:	Fish and Other Marine Products	937.09 976.18
	Section:	Salt (Chlorine as Sodium Chloride)	
Sodium	Chapter:	Fish and Other Marine Products	969.23
	Section:	Sodium and Potassium in Seafood	

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is available and sold to the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, processing, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered product shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. Delivered product shall also meet with the provisions of Regulations found in CFR 50, Subchapter G - Processed Fishery Products, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Food Products, Part 260, Inspection and Certification.

Quality assurance.

Compliance with this CID shall be determined by the U.S. Department of Commerce (USDC), National Marine Fisheries Service (NMFS). NMFS will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to assure

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specification compliance. The cost of all services performed by NMFS agents involving examination, supervision, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

The canned salmon shall be inspected by USDC, NMFS, under Type I continuous inspection in accordance with this CID for Federal, State, and military purchases when so contracted.

External examination for condition of containers will be conducted using the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers (7 CFR Part 42) in accordance with NMFS policies and procedures.

Internal examination for condition of containers shall be in accordance with NMFS policies and procedures. Assurance of can requirements may be based on the acceptance of a certificate of conformance.

Sampling for inspection and determination of acceptability shall be done in accordance with provisions set forth in the Military Standard, MIL-STD-105 currently in effect on the date of the solicitation. Defects found during inspection shall be classified in accordance with Tables III through VIII at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) as shown below. AQL's shall be expressed in defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be expressed in cans.

TABLE II. Inspection levels and acceptance numbers

Table	Inspection level 1/	AQL	
		Major	Minor
III	S3	---	6.5
IV	S3	---	6.5
V	S3	---	6.5
VI	S3	---	6.5
VII	S3	1.5	6.5
VIII	S2	1.5	6.5

1/ Sample shipping containers shall be selected randomly on a proportionate basis from not less than 90 percent of the code listed in a lot or on the warehouse receipts. In the event that the referenced levels result in a sample size that is too small to provide for sampling 90 percent of the codes in a lot or on the warehouse receipts, a level sufficiently large to accommodate this requirement shall be selected. Not more than one primary container per shipping container shall be examined for the defects within the tables listed in Table II.

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The sample unit for USDC Inspection is the contents of one can. For sampling purposes, the maximum lot size will be the quantity of product produced on a single line during an 8-hour production shift. The lot size may be reduced by the USDC inspector if necessary. If a plant operates two or more lines under inspection simultaneously, the products from each line will be inspected as separate lots. Also, if a plant wishes to extend the processing day beyond a normal 8-hour shift, the product produced after the end of the 8-hour shift will be inspected as a new lot. For labeling and identification purposes, production lots shall be numbered in sequence. For purposes of lot identification, in addition to the requirements contained in 21 CFR Part 113, a code change will be necessary when a shift concludes or a new shift begins.

If a plant operates more than one line under inspection, it may be necessary to assign an inspector to each line. This is to enable the inspector to have sufficient time to perform a sanitation inspection, examination for product characteristics, condition of container examination, etc., and still have sufficient time to observe the materials being processed to ensure their suitability for processing.

The contractor shall obtain a USDC Certificate of Inspection which state(s) the product meets all requirements of this CID.

TABLE III. Examination for net weights 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	A single primary container with more than 5 percent under specified weight.

1/ Failure of lot average net weight to meet specified net weight shall be basis for rejection of entire lot.

2/ Report results to the nearest 0.1 ounce (2.835 g).

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TABLE IV. Examination for vacuum requirements

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Less than 5 inches (12.7 cm).

TABLE V. Examination of cross fill

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Cross fill. 1/

1/ The vertebral column not generally parallel to the vertical axis of the can.

TABLE VI. Examination of pieces and patches

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Pink salmon only. More than 5 pieces and 1 patch in cans less than or equal to 16 ounces (453.59 g). More than 12 pieces and 1 patch in 64-ounce cans (1,814.37 g). 1/ All other salmon. More than 3 pieces and 1 patch in cans less than or equal to 16 ounces (453.59 g). More than 12 pieces and 1 patch in 64-ounce cans (1,814.37 g). 1/

1/ A patch is a small portion of salmon which is added, if necessary, to complete the fill of the container. A patch is any small portion less than 1 ounce (28.35 g).

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TABLE VII. Product defects

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
1			Flesh showing evidence of true honeycombing or the presence of flavors and/or odors of decomposition such as, but not limited to, sour and rancid, or other flavors or odors of decomposition. 1/ 2/
	101		Presence of objectional flavors or odors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, overcooked, stale, or other objectionable flavors or odors, or flavors or odors of watermarking (hominy, muddy). 3/
	102		Presence of objectionable foreign material, such as, but not limited to, rust, wood, hair, dirt, or insect or insect parts either singly or in combination. 4/
	103		Bones hard, not soft and friable. 5/
	104		Species of salmon not as specified.
	105		Presence of struvite crystals.
		201	Presence of watermarking indicated by the color change of the normal white area (i.e. belly) to another color characteristic of the species (Style I only).
		202	Presence of gills, fins, or viscera.
		203	Color of flesh not characteristic of species.
		204	Color of oil not characteristic of species.
		205	Texture not characteristic of species.
		206	Presence of skin and backbone (Style II only). 6/
		207	Presence of blood clots, mutilated areas, or bruises. 7/
		208	Sulfide blackening.

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TABLE VII. Product defects (continued)

1/ These are regarded as critical defects and their finding will be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

2/ Honeycombing is the visible appearance of discrete holes or openings of varying size observed in the salmon flesh.

3/ Do not include flavors and odors of decomposition.

4/ Presence of chemicals, glass, or metal particles, animal excreta, or simlar extraneous material which could harmfully affect or contaminate the product (critical defects) shall be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

5/ Hard bones are those which are not soft or friable. Bones are soft and friable if the vertebrae are easily crushed when pressed between thumb and fingers. Bones should be brittle and breakable with slight distorting finger pressure. Thermal processing records should be carefully reviewed and process authorities should be consulted if necessary.

6/ Minor 206 is a defect if the skin and backbone is not removed in accordance with good manufacturing practices. If the majority of sample units are defects, the lot may be relabeled as Style I.

7/ Mutilated areas are areas of flesh which are not physically intact due to mechanical or predatory damage. Blood clots or bruises are those which detract from the appearance of the product. Minute blood streaks or blood spots which do not materially affect the appearance are not a defect.

TABLE VIII. Can interior enamel coating defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Missing enamel coating.
102		Blistered or softened enamel coating which can be peeled by fingertip (not fingernail abrasion).
103		Enamel coating with internal rust stains.
	201	Enamel coating with bare areas (other than scratches). 1/
	202	Enamel coating that is dirty, stained, or smeared with foreign material.

1/ A line of solder along the side seam shall not be considered a defect.

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Testing for salt content or sodium content.

The composite for testing for salt content or sodium content shall be a composite of 24 ounces (680.39 g) of product. The minimum number of sample units to use for deriving the composite for salt or sodium content is eight sample units. The sample units shall represent all the codes selected for product evaluation. Equal amounts of product will be taken from each selected sample unit and from each code. If the sample size is too small to provide for sampling all codes, more sample units may be selected with less product taken from each can.

At least two tests from a composite sample shall be performed and the results averaged. Results of testing shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent.

Failure to meet salt/sodium levels specified in the contract or CID shall be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The canned salmon shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Can codes shall appear on the outside of the master case. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall be a minimum of 275 pounds (124.74 kg) bursting strength. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packing. Cans shall be packed in fiberboard boxes complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

B. Export packing. Cans shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

C. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

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D. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

E. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Purchasers should specify:

- Species
- Style
- Salt/sodium level
- Net weight
- Can and case size
- Number of cans per case and can size
  Labeling, packaging, and casing requirements if different from commercial practice.

Sources of documents.

Sources of information for nongovernment documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

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Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of the Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products are available from:

National Marine Fisheries Service
Office of Trade and Industry Services
Inspection Services Division
1335 East-West Highway
Silver Spring, MD 20910

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

COM - NMF

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